

Sally Berson

CONTACT	3400 N Charles Street, Baltimore, MD 21218	email: sberson1@jh.edu website: sallyberson.github.io
EDUCATION	Ph.D., Psychological & Brain Sciences, Johns Hopkins University Advisor: Lisa Feigenson	2023 – present
	BA, Cognitive Science BA, Biopsychology, Cognition, & Neuroscience University of Michigan <i>with distinction and high honors</i>	2019 – 2023

HONORS, AWARDS, & FELLOWSHIPS	Diverse Intelligences Natural & Artificial Minds Fellowship, <i>Princeton University</i>	2026 2025
	Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention, <i>National Science Foundation</i>	2023
	Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society	
	High Honors for Senior Thesis, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2023
	James B. Angell Scholar, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2021 – 2023
	University Honors, <i>University of Michigan</i>	2019 – 2023

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	Berson, S., & Feigenson, L. (2026). Infants evaluate and generate explanations for surprising events. Talk presented at the 52 nd Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy & Psychology. Baltimore, MD	
	Berson, S., & Feigenson, L. (2026). Can infants generate explanations? Poster presented at the Cognitive Development Society Conference. Montréal, QC	
	Berson, S., & Feigenson, L. (2025). Core knowledge influences explanatory reasoning. Poster presented at the 47 th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society. San Francisco, CA	
	Berson, S., & Feigenson, L. (2025). Children’s explanations for surprising events. Poster presented at the 51 st Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy & Psychology. Ithaca, NY	

PUBLICATIONS		
<i>Journal Articles</i>	*equal contribution	
	Berson, S., & Feigenson, L. (in prep). Mechanistic knowledge shapes when children explain teleologically.	
	Berson, S.*, Joo, S.*, Keil, F., & Yousif, S. (in prep). How children understand ‘why’.	
	Berson, S., Feigenson, L., & Liu, S. (forthcoming). Core perception cannot ignore issues of conceptual content and functional role [commentary]. <i>Behavioral and Brain Sciences</i> .	

Berson, S., Pappagallo, E., Ripley, O., & Zehner, A. (2023). Preferential Unconscious Attention for Pictures over Words in a Visual Recognition Paradigm. *The Canadian Undergraduate Journal of Cognitive Science*.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Graduate Student Researcher	2023 – present
	Laboratory for Child Development Johns Hopkins University Principal Investigators: Lisa Feigenson, Justin Halberda	
	Undergraduate Research Assistant	2019 – 2023
	Neuropsychology and Cognitive Aging Lab University of Michigan Principal Investigator: Laura Zahodne	
	Undergraduate Research Assistant	2022
	Cognitive Neuroscience of Consciousness Lab Danish Institute for Study Abroad Principal Investigator: Claudia Carrara-Augustenberg	

MENTORSHIP

<i>Undergraduate Students</i>	*honors student	
	Samuel Vidomlanski, Johns Hopkins University	2026 –
	Aliza Tharani, Johns Hopkins University	2026 –
	Shayan Lalani, University of Georgia	2026
	Chloe Patz, Wake Forest University	2025 – 2026
	Esther Kehinde*, Johns Hopkins University	2025 – 2026
	Claire Han, Johns Hopkins University	2025 – 2026
	Priscilla Animadu*, Johns Hopkins University	2024 – 2026
	Natalie Bernstein, Johns Hopkins University	2024

TEACHING

<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i>	Introduction to Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2026
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i>	Introduction to Cognitive Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2026
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant</i>	Research Methods in Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2025
<i>Graduate Teaching Assistant & Guest Lecturer</i>	Introduction to Developmental Psychology, <i>Johns Hopkins University</i>	2024